



The next key piece of the German pension reform puzzle

Today, the next key piece of the German pension reform puzzle has been officially revealed. The expert commission on pension reform has [released](#) its 33 proposals on how to reform and complement the German public statutory pension system.

As expected, the proposals contain many well-known measures to stabilize the pay-as-you-go statutory pension system, like slowly and moderately increasing the pension age (from 67 to 67.5 until 2041), limiting costly early retirement programs and raising the number of contributors by including self-employed persons. The aggregate effect of all the proposals is a stabilisation of contributions to the PAYG system in the medium term (compared to the status quo ante). The overall package has been [welcomed](#) by key German business associations¹ and should contribute to lifting sentiment.

Second, we would like to highlight a more surprising and game-changing element. This is the introduction of a mandatory funded component, with 2 pp of gross salaries to be additionally invested in a centralized public pension fund (with some phasing in until 2031). This will eventually add up to EUR 35 bn in [additional](#) investments into capital markets with no pre-defined asset allocation or country split. Sweden's "premium pension" serves as a model here. Thus, next to making Germany's public pension system more sustainable given the ageing society, an additional boost to German/European capital markets can potentially be expected.

With respect to timelines, there are two key dates/points in time to watch. All the mentioned proposals are subject to potential changes until a formal political compromise by both ruling parties has been found on July 1. Both coalition partners [stressed](#) in today's press conference that this is a package deal with "no cherry-picking" of certain measures envisaged. The July 1 coalition committee meeting is the self-set deadline for agreeing on an income tax reform (see our note [here](#)) and a comprehensive reform of the statutory pension system. The second point in time to watch is the autumn legislative process, where details of the reform will be ironed out and (according to another self-set timeline) approved until year-end.

Below, we provide additional details on the main game-changing and sustainability-enhancing parts of the reform.

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1 [Vielversprechendes Paket - Umsetzung nicht verzögern](#)



Surprising game-changer - a mandatory funded component in the public pension system

Up to 2 pps of gross salaries (to be equally shared between employee and employer) are to be invested in capital markets so that every insured person can benefit from capital market gains in the future. As a standard option, these contributions would be invested with a centralized public fund. This could generate EUR 30-35 bn of capital market investment per year. Sweden's "premium pension" serves as a model. Alongside the [overhauled private pension](#), this would generate another capital-market oriented element in the German retirement system.

Important features of the funded component are yet to be decided by policymakers during the legislative process in autumn and during the implementation:

- **Exact volume of contributions.** The commission proposes to start with 0.5 pp of mandatory contributions in 2028, rising to 2 pp by 2031. Initially, this would result in about EUR 8 bn in new money into capital markets, doubling in 2029 to EUR 16-17 bn and reaching around EUR 30-35 bn by 2031. Once the phase-in details have been put into legislation, volumes will be relatively predictable given the mandatory nature of the scheme, in contrast to the reformed private pensions which require an opt-in. To put the final EUR 30-35 bn into perspective: it would be a substantial number, but is likely to be somewhat less than the gross funds the revamped private pension may raise, which could amount to about EUR 50 bn p.a.
- **Public fund administration.** Germany does not have a sovereign wealth fund or public asset manager yet. Establishing such an "infrastructure", probably linked to an institution like Bundesbank, KfW or Kenfo, will be crucial. That is all the more true given that a public fund offering is also part of the already enacted private pension reform taking effect on January 1, and part of the agreed-on ["early start pension"](#) which has yet to be adopted.
- **Asset allocation.** The pension commission only foresees "investment in capital markets", without specifying equities or fixed income. The split will depend on requirements set by policymakers during the legislative process in autumn and by the future asset manager in charge of the portfolio. By introducing this funded component to the system, the commission aims to raise the pension level in the longer term. To achieve the required returns (and follow the "Swedish role model"), a strong focus on the stock market (in contrast to e.g. government bonds) would be required.
- **Total pension contributions.** The 2 pp capital market investment will be financed via "additional contributions". However, the current setup already envisages contributions to the pay-as-you-go (PAYG) system to rise from today's 18.6% of salaries to a projected 21.8% by 2040.² It remains to be seen whether the new capital market component will be sufficient to prevent any rise in PAYG contributions in future.

2 See [German Council of Economic Experts](#), May 2026



Well-known reform proposals to stabilize the statutory pension system

The aggregate effect of all the proposals below is a stabilisation of contributions to the PAYG pension system in the medium term (compared to the status quo ante). The overall package has been welcomed by key German business associations³ and should contribute to lifting sentiment.

- **Linking the retirement age to life expectancy.** The commission proposes to link the retirement age to life expectancy from 2031 onwards. If life expectancy were to develop according to the current median assumptions of the Federal Statistical Office, it would mean that the standard retirement age would gradually be raised by about six months from 67 to 67.5 years during the period between 2031 and 2041.
- **Reintroduction of the so-called sustainability factor.** This automatically dampens pension increases when there are fewer contributors. The government is bringing back a tool that has been used previously to manage pension finances.
- **Eliminating costly early retirement programs.** The qualifying age for the early, deduction-free pension after long contribution periods (called "Rente mit 63") has already been phased up to 65 by 2031 and could be removed altogether.
- **"Minijobs" no longer exempt from tax and social security contributions.** Employees working only a few hours and earning up to EUR 603 per month would no longer be exempt from tax and social security contributions. This would primarily affect employees in the hospitality, retail, health and social services, and could especially bring women into the statutory pension system.
- **Including self-employed persons (and members of parliament) in the statutory pension system.** This would raise the number of contributors in the medium-run, even though currently self-employed people will be granted an opt-out option. There are about 3.7 m self-employed in Germany.
- **Enhancing the reach of occupational pensions,** to be further worked out between the tariff partners. So far, only just over half of those in compulsory social insurance have such a provision. Small and medium-sized enterprises, in particular, do not offer corresponding schemes, as the existing system is often too expensive and complex for them. Additionally, people with low incomes usually do not have an occupational pension. Automatic inclusion – possibly with an opt-out option – could help to mitigate social disparities, also with regard to the gender pension gap, i.e., the pension gap between men and women.

³ FAZ, So groß ist der Widerstand gegen die Swedenrente, Juni 23, 2026



Appendix 1

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